

HUMAN RESOURCES

Employee Handbook

Company overview, organisation structure, employment terms, conduct and performance management

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Applies to	All employees	Classification	Internal - Confidential

Abstract. The Employee Handbook introduces Nexora Technologies, its values and organisation structure, and explains the terms of employment, working hours, code of conduct, performance review cycle, disciplinary process and exit procedure. It is the primary reference for new joiners and is supplemented by the Leave Policy, Benefits Guide, Expense Policy and Coding Standards. Employee grades G1 to G6 defined here are used across all other policies.

Keywords: employee handbook, grades, probation, notice period, performance review, disciplinary process, code of conduct

1. About Nexora Technologies

Nexora Technologies (Pvt.) Ltd. is a software company founded in 2016 and headquartered in Gulberg III, Lahore, with offices in Karachi and Islamabad. Nexora builds AI-powered customer-support and workflow-automation software (NexaDesk, NexaFlow and NexaInsight) used by over 1,200 business customers. The company employs approximately 450 people; Figure 1 shows the distribution by department.

1.1 Company Values

- **Integrity** - we are honest with customers, colleagues and regulators.
- **Ownership** - we take responsibility for outcomes, not only tasks.
- **Craft** - we care about the quality of what we build and how we build it.
- **Collaboration** - we share knowledge and succeed as teams.

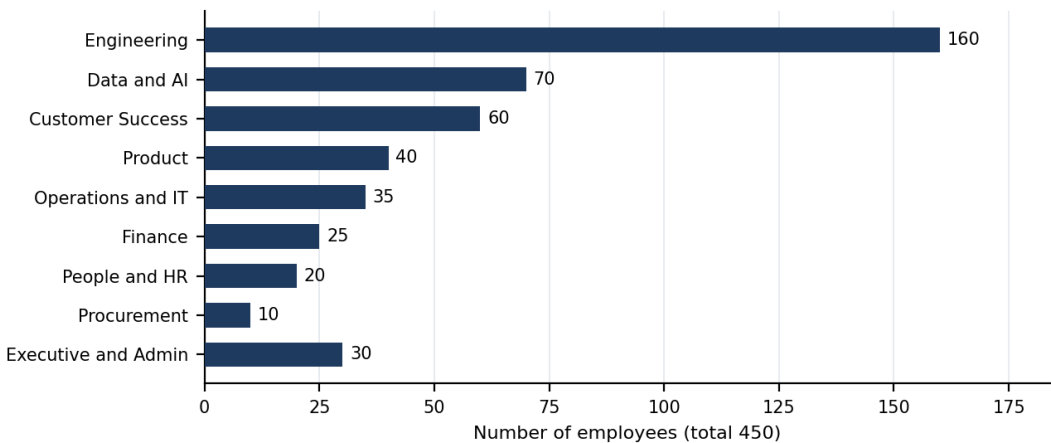


Figure 1. Employee headcount by department.

2. Organisation Structure

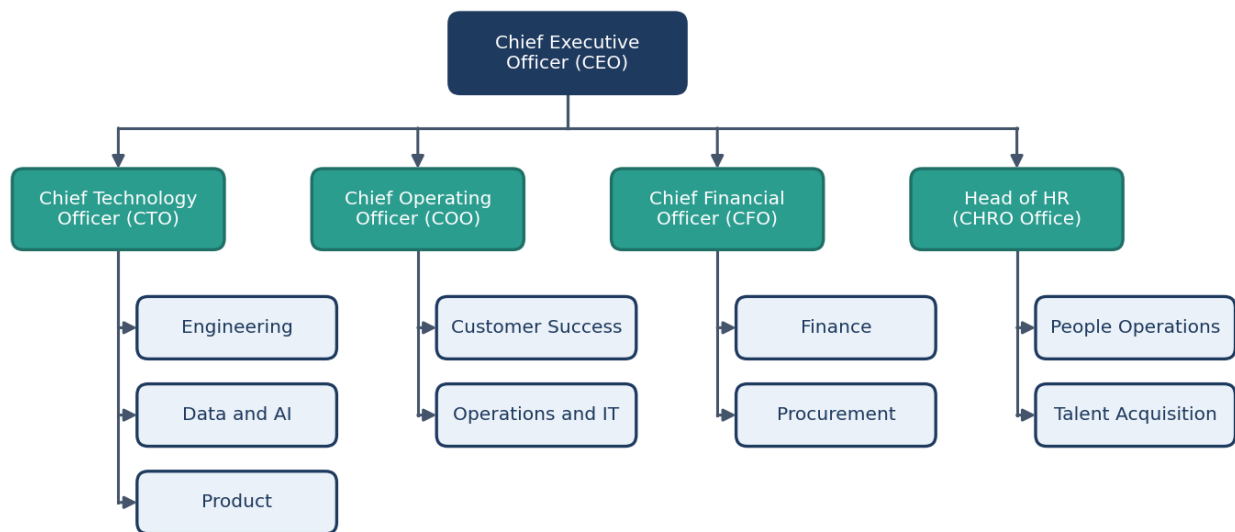


Figure 2. Nexora organisation chart (executive level and departments).

3. Employment Terms

3.1 Grades

Table 1. Employee grade structure.

Grade	Typical titles	Typical experience
G1	Associate Engineer, Associate Executive, Intern (converted)	0 to 2 years
G2	Engineer, Executive, Analyst	1 to 4 years
G3	Senior Engineer, Senior Executive	3 to 7 years
G4	Team Lead, Manager	6 to 10 years
G5	Director, Head of Department	10 or more years
G6	Vice President, C-level executive	Executive leadership

3.2 Probation, Confirmation and Notice

New employees serve a probation period of **3 months**, which may be extended once by up to 3 months. Confirmation is issued in writing after a satisfactory review by the line manager and HR. During probation either party may end employment with 7 days' notice. After confirmation, the notice period is **1 month** for grades G1 to G3 and **2 months** for grades G4 to G6. Notice can be waived or shortened only by the department head and Head of HR.

4. Working Hours and Attendance

Nexora is an office-based company. Employees are expected to work from their assigned office; remote work is allowed only with written approval of the department head and for a defined period.

Table 2. Standard working hours (Pakistan Standard Time).

Item	Rule
Working days	Monday to Friday
Office hours	9:00 AM to 6:00 PM including a 1-hour lunch and prayer break
Friday break	12:30 PM to 2:30 PM to allow for Jumu'ah prayers
Grace period	15 minutes, up to 3 times per month; further late arrivals are marked as half-day absence
Overtime	Not paid for G3 and above. G1 and G2 support staff on shift work receive compensatory time off
On-call	Engineering on-call rotation is described in the Deployment SOP; on-call allowance is in the Benefits Guide

5. Code of Conduct

- Treat colleagues, customers and vendors with respect. Harassment, discrimination and bullying are not tolerated.
- **Dress code:** business casual from Monday to Thursday; smart casual on Friday. Client-facing staff follow business formal for meetings.
- Declare any conflict of interest (for example a family member working for a vendor) to HR in writing.
- Do not accept gifts from vendors worth more than PKR 5,000; report offers above that limit to Finance.
- Protect customer data. Company laptops must use disk encryption, and customer data must never be copied to personal devices or personal cloud storage.
- Use approved AI tools only. Do not paste source code, customer data or credentials into public AI services.

6. Performance Management

Nexora runs an annual performance cycle with a mid-year review (Figure 3). Goals are written as 3 to 5 measurable objectives agreed between the employee and line manager. Ratings are calibrated across departments by a committee chaired by the CEO to keep standards consistent.

**Figure 3.** Annual performance management cycle.**Table 3.** Performance rating scale and annual increment bands.

Rating	Description	Increment band
5	Outstanding - consistently exceeds expectations and raises the bar for the team	12% to 15% of basic salary
4	Exceeds expectations	8% to 11%
3	Meets expectations	5% to 7%
2	Needs improvement - a 90-day performance plan is issued	0% to 3%
1	Unsatisfactory	No increment

7. Disciplinary Process

Nexora follows a progressive disciplinary approach for misconduct that is not serious enough to justify immediate termination. Gross misconduct (fraud, harassment, theft, serious data breach) may lead to immediate termination after an inquiry.

Table 4. Progressive disciplinary steps.

Step	Action	Validity
1	Verbal warning recorded by line manager and HR	6 months
2	Written warning placed on the personnel file	12 months
3	Final written warning; may include suspension without pay for up to 3 days	12 months
4	Termination after inquiry by a committee of HR and a department head not in the employee's reporting line	-

8. Grievances and Workplace Harassment

Employees may raise concerns with their line manager, the HR business partner or, where the concern involves either, directly with the Head of HR. Complaints of harassment are handled by the Inquiry Committee constituted under the Protection against Harassment of Women at the Workplace Act, 2010; a complaint may be filed in writing or by email to the committee, and the committee completes its inquiry within 30 days. Retaliation against a complainant is itself gross misconduct.

9. Exit Procedure

On resignation the employee submits a written notice to the line manager and HR. A knowledge-transfer plan is agreed within the first week of the notice period. On the last working day the employee returns laptops, access cards and other assets; IT revokes all access by 6:00 PM. Final settlement (salary, leave encashment, provident fund and gratuity as per the Benefits Guide) is paid within 30 days of the last working day, after clearance from IT, Finance and HR.

10. References

[1] Nexora Leave Policy, NX-HR-001.

[2] Nexora Benefits Guide, NX-HR-003.

[3] Nexora Expense Policy, NX-FIN-001 (grade-based limits).

[4] Protection against Harassment of Women at the Workplace Act, 2010 (Pakistan).

11. Revision History

Table 5. Document revision history.

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
3.0	01 Jan 2025	Nexora HR Policy Committee	Introduced G1 to G6 grade structure
4.0	01 Jul 2025	Nexora HR Policy Committee	Updated notice periods and rating scale
4.1	01 Jan 2026	Nexora HR Policy Committee	Added AI tool usage rule and Friday break timing